

Assignment: Layers of Culture

Group 6

1

Appearance

What we can see directly



Shape & Pattern: Depend on the type of tteok. Some are cylindrical and some are slices and some are slabs.

Color: Depend on the type of tteok. Most of them are plain white but some are in colorful color like pink, green, orange.

Ingredient: Tteok are mainly made of the sticky rice flour. Some type of tteoks have the filling inside or coated on the outside.

Texture: Chewy, elastic, dense, and soft

Size: Depend on the type of tteok but most of it are in the bite-sized.

Smell: Mild, warm, starchy rice aroma

2

Process

How is it made? Who creates or practises it? What knowledge, skills, time, or resources are needed?

Process: Soaking rice, grinding it into flour, steaming, and traditionally pounding the dough using large wooden mallets to achieve its signature elasticity before shaping.

Producers: Historically crafted by women in households; today, made by specialized traditional confectioners (Tteok artisans) and local rice-cake shops.

Skills Required: Precise knowledge of rice-to-water ratios, steaming temperature, and rhythmic dough-pounding technique.

3

Relationship

Who is involved? How does it connect people, families, or communities?

Making and sharing Tteok helps bring families and communities together. During Chuseok, families make songjeond spend time talking and cooking. Tteok is also a way to show kindness and celebrate special events. People may share Tteok with neighbors during housewarmings, weddings, or a baby's 100th day. It is an important part of Korean culture.

4

Culture and ways of living

What cultural values or ways of life can be seen in this? How does it reflect beliefs, traditions, or identity?

Core Values & Beliefs: Tteok reflects the value of communal harmony, sharing, and wishing for pure beginnings, good health, and long life through tradition (Seollal and Chuseok).

Livelihoods & Agrarian Society: As rice is the staple crop of Korea, converting rice into Tteok shows the agrarian society's deep respect for grain, harvest, and food preservation.

Gender & Generational Roles: Making Tteok historically involved the whole household, men often did the heavy pounding while women shaped and steamed it, passing traditional knowledge down across generations.

Collective Identity: Tteok serves as a shared cultural symbol for Koreans everywhere, bridging traditional ceremonial identity with modern street-food lifestyle (Tteokbokki).

5

Value and meaning

Who does this have meaning for, and why is it important?

Making tteok is considered a community gathering activity. Families come together to make this dessert, a way to strengthen relationships and foster unity.

In modern times, tteok has evolved to meet diverse consumer demands such as Gyeongdan and Garaetteok which are key ingredients in Tteokbokki a popular Korean street food dish. The spread of Korean food culture has made tteok popular worldwide with new sweet flavors being adapted to cater to a wide range of consumers.



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O - Observation



Select details, images, or traces that you can observe from what you are studying. These details will be used for further understanding and interpretation.

There are many type of tteok so the shape, pattern and color and very various.

Some are cylindrical, slices or slabs.

Some are white, pink, green or orange.

The main ingredient are a sticky rice flour.

Some pieces appear filled or coated on the outside.

The texture of the tteok is chewy, dense, elastic and soft.

The size are mostly in bite-size.

The smell is mild with the starchy rice aroma.

F - Fact / Information



Information from reference sources

Tteok is a traditional Korean food with over 1,000 years of history made from non-glutinous or glutinous rice flour, steamed, boiled, or hand-shaped. Ancient records trace its roots back to the Three Kingdoms period, where rice was washed, ground, mixed with herbs or flowers, and steamed. During the Goryeo and Joseon dynasties, varieties like Baekseolgi, Injeolmi, and Songpyeon evolved, becoming vital parts of weddings, birthdays, and major festivals (Seollal and Chuseok). Today, forms like Garaetteok and Gyeongdan remain central to Korean culture and global K-food trends.

I - Interpretation



Value or meaning from the information

The physical characteristics of Tteok, including its various shapes and signature chewiness, combined with its long history as a festive food, interpret Tteok as much more than just nourishment. Its elasticity symbolizes resilience, unity, and strong bonds within Korean families and communities. Furthermore, its evolution from traditional ceremonial offerings to global modern street food demonstrates how Korean culture successfully preserves its core values of warmth and sharing while continuously adapting to modern lifestyles.



Evidence used

- ☒ photos
- ☐ observation
- ☐ supporting documents and reference



- ☒ other **website**
<https://www.rimping.com/th/blog/7264/korean-traditional-rice-cake-tteok>



The beauty and value discovered

From your perspective, where does the beauty of the object lie, and what information supports your conclusion?

The beauty of tteok lies in it has ability to foster the human connection and adapt across a generation and cultures. Making tteok is a collective activity that brings families and communities together. Moreover, it represents a local wisdom passed down through generations. Nowadays, tteok evolves into the modern dishes like Tteokbokki and goes to the global tastes.



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